Project: Worked examples
Title: Pipe pressure drop and pump duty
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1. Scope and method

Friction and fitting losses through series pipe segments at a given flow, the static head, the system curve, the duty point against a pump curve entered as points, the affinity-law shift for a speed or impeller change, and the NPSH available at the pump suction.

WHAT IT CALCULATES	RELATION
Mean velocity in the pipe	$v = Q/(\pi D^2/4)$
Reynolds number, which decides laminar or turbulent flow	$Re = \rho v D/\mu$
Friction factor for laminar flow (Re < 2300)	$f = 64/Re$
Friction factor for turbulent flow, Colebrook–White by fixed-point iteration (at most 100 steps) from the Swamee–Jain value, which also cross-checks it	$1/\sqrt{f} = -2 \log10(\varepsilon/3.7D + 2.51/(Re\sqrt{f}))$
Head lost in the pipe and its fittings	$h_f = f\,(L + L_{eq})/D \cdot v^2/2g + K\,v^2/2g$
System curve, with friction scaled from the design flow as Q^2	$H_{sys}(Q) = \Sigma dz + h_{out} + \Sigma h_f(Q)$
Duty point, where the pump and system curves cross (found by bisection)	$H_{pump}(Q) = H_{sys}(Q)$
Pump affinity laws for a change of speed n or impeller diameter D	$Q \propto n\,D^3$; $H \propto n^2\,D^2$
Net positive suction head available, to compare with what the pump requires	$NPSH_a = p_{atm}/\rho g + z_s - h_{f,suction} - p_v/\rho g$

Basis: Flow of fluids through valves, fittings and pipe[1]; Internal flow: friction factor, minor losses, pump duty[2](Ch. 8); Flow of fluids in pipes and ducts (principles)[3](Section 4); Density of liquid water[4].

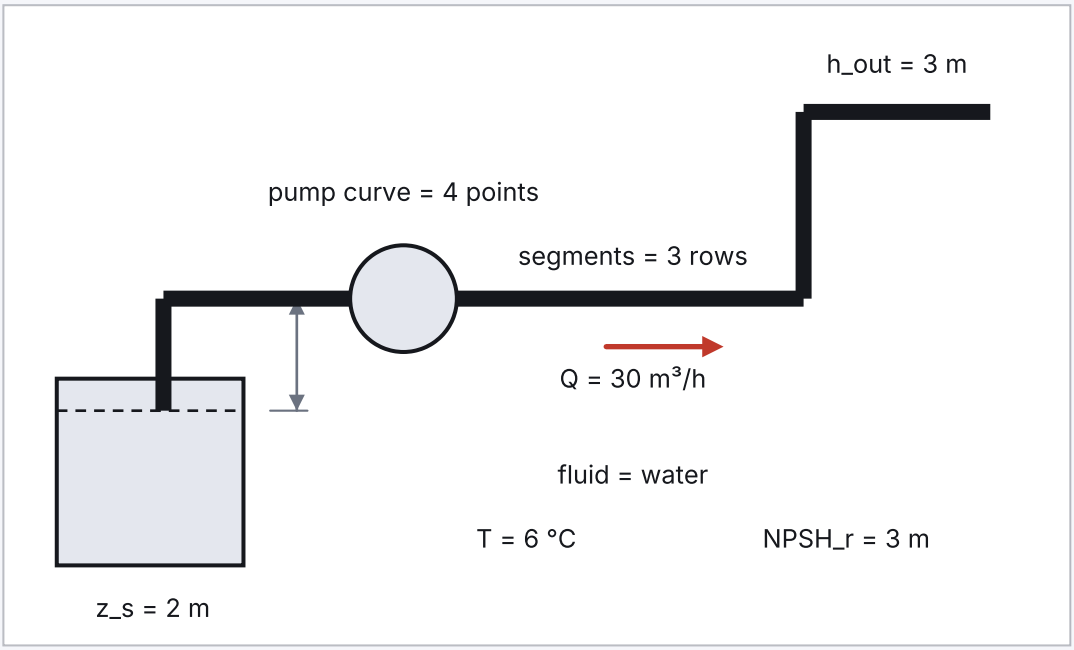


Figure 1 — A pump lifting from a suction level through the pipe segments as listed (three drawn) to an outlet that needs a pressure head. Not to scale; the labels are the inputs as entered.

2. Inputs

SYMBOL	DESCRIPTION	VALUE	UNIT	SOURCE	VALID RANGE
fluid	Fluid	water		spec: SPEC-M-04 §3: chilled water, no glycol	any
T	Fluid temperature	6	°C	spec: SPEC-M-04 §3: 6 °C flow	0 … 100 °C
Q	Design flow rate	30	m³/h	spec: Schedule CHW-01 design flow	0.01 … 100000 m³/h
segments	Pipe segments in series	3 row(s)		drawing: DRG-M-110 rev C	any
h_out	Pressure head required at the outlet	3	m	spec: Terminal unit: 30 kPa ≈ 3 m	0 … 1000 m
v_max	Velocity limit (warning)	2.5	m/s	spec: CIBSE Guide C practice limit, assumed	0.5 … 10 m/s
Q_pump	Pump curve: flow points	[0, 20, 40, 60]	m³/h	spec: Pump datasheet P-01 rev 2, curve points	any
H_pump	Pump curve: head points	[40, 36, 24, 4]	m	spec: Pump datasheet P-01 rev 2, curve points	any
n_ratio	Speed ratio n_2/n_1 (affinity)	0.9		assumption: Inverter turn-down to 90 % speed.	0.2 … 2

SYMBOL	DESCRIPTION	VALUE	UNIT	SOURCE	VALID RANGE
D_ratio	Impeller diameter ratio D_2/D_1 (affinity)	1		assumption: Impeller unchanged.	0.7 … 1.1
eta_pump	Pump efficiency at duty (for shaft power)	0.68		spec: Pump datasheet P-01 rev 2	0.2 … 0.95
p_atm	Atmospheric pressure (NPSH)	101.325	kPa	assumption: Sea level.	50 … 110 kPa
z_s	Static head at the pump suction (+ flooded, − lift)	2	m	drawing: DRG-M-110 rev C	-10 … 100 m
NPSH_r	NPSH required by the pump (optional)	3	m	spec: Pump datasheet P-01 rev 2	0 … 50 m

TABLE ROW	VALUES
segments[1]	name = plantroom suction; L = 8 m; D = 100 mm; eps = 0.045 mm; K = 3; L_eq = 0 m; dz = 0 m; side = suction
segments[2]	name = riser DN80; L = 60 m; D = 80 mm; eps = 0.045 mm; K = 8; L_eq = 0 m; dz = 10 m; side = discharge
segments[3]	name = index run DN65; L = 45 m; D = 65 mm; eps = 0.045 mm; K = 12; L_eq = 6 m; dz = 2 m; side = discharge

3. Assumptions

A1. Steady, incompressible, fully developed flow; all segments carry the full design flow in series. (Darcy–Weisbach.)
A2. Fitting losses scale with velocity head (K method) or add pipe length (equivalent-length method); both may be used on one segment. (Crane TP-410 practice.)
A3. The system curve scales friction losses with Q^2 from the design flow (turbulent assumption); the static part is independent of flow. ($H_{sys} = H_{static} + k\,Q^2$.)
A4. Water properties are from published correlations at atmospheric pressure (0–100 °C); any other fluid is entered with its own density and viscosity and their provenance. (Kell 1975; Vogel fit; Hyland & Wexler 1983.)
A5. n_ratio (Speed ratio n_2/n_1 (affinity)) is taken as 0.9. (Inverter turn-down to 90 % speed.)
A6. D_ratio (Impeller diameter ratio D_2/D_1 (affinity)) is taken as 1. (Impeller unchanged.)
A7. p_atm (Atmospheric pressure (NPSH)) is taken as 101.325 kPa. (Sea level.)

4. Working

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[3] rho = Kell (1975) density of water at T                                  [4]
= T = 6 °C
= 999.94 kg/m³
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Density
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[4] mu = Vogel fit μ = 0.02939 exp(507.88/(T_K - 149.3)) mPa·s
= T_K = 279.15 K
= 1.4684 mPa·s
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Dynamic viscosity
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[5] p_v = Hyland–Wexler saturation pressure
= T = 6 °C
= 0.93525 kPa
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Vapour pressure (NPSH)

[9] v_s1 = plantroom suction: Q / (π D²/4)
= 30 m³/h / (π × 100² mm² / 4)
= 1.061 m/s
Velocity, plantroom suction
[10] Re_s1 = plantroom suction: ρ v D / μ
= 999.94 × 1.061 × 0.1 / 0.0014684
= 72253
Reynolds number, plantroom suction
[11] f_s1 = plantroom suction: Darcy friction factor
= Colebrook–White, 10 iterations (Swamee–Jain start 0.021152)
= 0.021093
Friction factor, plantroom suction
[12] f_sj_s1 = plantroom suction: Swamee–Jain check
= 0.25 / log10(ε/3.7D + 5.74/Re^0.9)²
= 0.021152
Explicit cross-check, plantroom suction
[13] h_f_s1 = plantroom suction: f (L + L_eq)/D · v²/2g + K v²/2g
= 0.021093 × (8 + 0) / 0.1 × 0.057399 + 3 × 0.057399
= 0.26906 m
Head loss, plantroom suction
[14] v_s2 = riser DN80: Q / (π D²/4)
= 30 m³/h / (π × 80² mm² / 4)
= 1.6579 m/s
Velocity, riser DN80
[15] Re_s2 = riser DN80: ρ v D / μ
= 999.94 × 1.6579 × 0.08 / 0.0014684
= 90316
Reynolds number, riser DN80
[16] f_s2 = riser DN80: Darcy friction factor
= Colebrook–White, 10 iterations (Swamee–Jain start 0.020946)
= 0.020849
Friction factor, riser DN80
[17] f_sj_s2 = riser DN80: Swamee–Jain check
= 0.25 / log10(ε/3.7D + 5.74/Re^0.9)²
= 0.020946
Explicit cross-check, riser DN80
[18] h_f_s2 = riser DN80: f (L + L_eq)/D · v²/2g + K v²/2g
= 0.020849 × (60 + 0) / 0.08 × 0.14014 + 8 × 0.14014
= 3.3123 m
Head loss, riser DN80
[19] v_s3 = index run DN65: Q / (π D²/4)
= 30 m³/h / (π × 65² mm² / 4)
= 2.5113 m/s
Velocity, index run DN65
[20] Re_s3 = index run DN65: ρ v D / μ
= 999.94 × 2.5113 × 0.065 / 0.0014684
= 111160
Reynolds number, index run DN65
[21] f_s3 = index run DN65: Darcy friction factor
= Colebrook–White, 9 iterations (Swamee–Jain start 0.020964)
= 0.020834
Friction factor, index run DN65

[22] f_sj_s3 = index run DN65: Swamee-Jain check
= 0.25 / log10(ε/3.7D + 5.74/Re^0.9)²
= 0.020964
Explicit cross-check, index run DN65
[23] h_f_s3 = index run DN65: f (L + L_eq)/D · v²/2g + K v²/2g
= 0.020834 × (45 + 6) / 0.065 × 0.32155 + 12 × 0.32155
= 9.1151 m
Head loss, index run DN65
[24] h_f_total = Σ h_f
= 3 segment(s)
= 12.696 m
Total friction and fitting loss at the design flow
[25] H_static = Σ dz + h_out
= 12 + 3
= 15 m
Static head
[26] H_sys = H_static + h_f_total
= 15 m + 12.696 m
= 27.696 m
System head at the design flow
[27] dp_total = rho * 9.80665 m/s^2 * h_f_total
= 999.94 kg/m³ × 9.80665 m/s^2 × 12.696 m
= 124.5 kPa
Friction pressure drop at the design flow
[28] dp_sys = rho * 9.80665 m/s^2 * H_sys
= 999.94 kg/m³ × 9.80665 m/s^2 × 27.696 m
= 271.59 kPa
System pressure at the design flow
[29] P_hyd = rho * 9.80665 m/s^2 * Q * H_sys
= 999.94 kg/m³ × 9.80665 m/s^2 × 30 m³/h × 27.696 m
= 2.2633 kW
Hydraulic power at the design point
[35] Q_duty = duty flow (as entered)
= H_pump(Q) = H_sys(Q), bisection
= 31.569 m³/h
Duty flow as entered
[36] H_duty = duty head (as entered)
= H_sys(31.569 m³/h)
= 29.059 m
Duty head as entered
[37] P_shaft = ρ g Q H / η
= 999.94 × 9.8066 × 0.008769 × 29.059 / 0.68
= 3.6747 kW
Shaft power at duty as entered
[38] affinity = $Q_2 = Q_1 (n_2/n_1)(D_2/D_1)^3$, $H_2 = H_1 (n_2/n_1)^2(D_2/D_1)^2$
= $n_2/n_1 = 0.9$, $D_2/D_1 = 1$
= "curve scaled"
Affinity laws applied to the pump curve
[39] Q_duty2 = duty flow (after the affinity shift)
= H_pump(Q) = H_sys(Q), bisection
= 26.238 m³/h
Duty flow after the affinity shift

[40] H_duty2 = duty head (after the affinity shift)
= H_sys(26.238 m³/h)
= 24.712 m
Duty head after the affinity shift
[41] P_shaft2 = ρ g Q H / η
= 999.94 × 9.8066 × 0.0072883 × 24.712 / 0.68
= 2.5972 kW
Shaft power at duty after the affinity shift
[44] h_f_suction = Σ h_f on the suction side
= 1 suction segment(s)
= 0.26906 m
Suction-side friction loss
[45] NPSH_a = p_atm / (rho * 9.80665 m/s^2) + z_s - h_f_suction - p_v / (rho * 9.80665 m/s^2)
= 101.32 kPa / (999.94 kg/m³ × 9.80665 m/s^2) + 2 m − 0.26906 m − 0.93525 kPa / (999.94 kg/m³ × 9.80665 m/s^2)
= 11.968 m
NPSH available
[47] u_npsh = NPSH_r / NPSH_a
= 3 m / 11.968 m
= 0.25066
NPSH utilisation (required / available)
[48] v_peak = highest segment velocity
= 2.5113 m/s
= 2.5113 m/s
Highest velocity
[49] u_v = v_peak / v_max
= 2.5113 / 2.5
= 1.0045
Velocity utilisation

5. Results

SYMBOL	VALUE	DESCRIPTION
v_s1	1.061 m/s	Velocity, plantroom suction
Re_s1	72253	Re, plantroom suction
f_s1	0.021093	f, plantroom suction
f_sj_s1	0.021152	f (Swamee–Jain), plantroom suction
h_f_s1	0.26906 m	h_f, plantroom suction
v_s2	1.6579 m/s	Velocity, riser DN80
Re_s2	90316	Re, riser DN80
f_s2	0.020849	f, riser DN80
f_sj_s2	0.020946	f (Swamee–Jain), riser DN80
h_f_s2	3.3123 m	h_f, riser DN80
v_s3	2.5113 m/s	Velocity, index run DN65
Re_s3	111160	Re, index run DN65
f_s3	0.020834	f, index run DN65
f_sj_s3	0.020964	f (Swamee–Jain), index run DN65

SYMBOL	VALUE	DESCRIPTION
h_f_s3	9.1151 m	h_f, index run DN65
h_f_total	12.696 m	Σ h_f
H_static	15 m	Static head
H_sys	27.696 m	System head at Q
dp_total	124.5 kPa	Friction Δp
dp_sys	271.59 kPa	System Δp
P_hyd	2.2633 kW	Hydraulic power
Q_duty	31.569 m³/h	Duty flow as entered
H_duty	29.059 m	Duty head as entered
P_shaft	3.6747 kW	Shaft power as entered
Q_duty2	26.238 m³/h	Duty flow after the affinity shift
H_duty2	24.712 m	Duty head after the affinity shift
P_shaft2	2.5972 kW	Shaft power after the affinity shift
NPSH_a	11.968 m	NPSH available
v_peak	2.5113 m/s	Highest velocity

6. Checks (governing first)

RESULT	CHECK	DEMAND	CAPACITY	UTILISATION	REF
FAIL	Velocity ≤ limit	u_v = 1.0045	u_v ≤ 1	1	
PASS	NPSH_r ≤ NPSH_a	u_npsh = 0.25066	u_npsh ≤ 1	0.251	
PASS	Duty point exists (as entered)	31.569 m³/h	29.059 m	0	
PASS	Duty point exists (after the affinity shift)	26.238 m³/h	24.712 m	0	

7. Applicability

WARNING — velocity: segments: index run DN65 runs at 2.5113 m/s, above the 2.5 m/s limit.

8. Verification

Template bs.pipe-pump@1.0.1 Content hash 332014d4a12dcd6a Engine calc-engine/1.0.0
Known-answer cases passed 3/3 Test run 2026-10-23 12:00 UTC TempestOS 0.26.0

9. References

1. Crane Co. Flow of Fluids Through Valves, Fittings and Pipe. Technical Paper No. 410. Crane Co.
2. Çengel YA, Cimbala JM. Fluid Mechanics: Fundamentals and Applications. 4th ed. McGraw-Hill Education; 2018.
3. Chartered Institution of Building Services Engineers. CIBSE Guide C: Reference Data. CIBSE; 2007.
4. Kell GS. Density, thermal expansivity, and compressibility of liquid water from 0° to 150°C: correlations and tables for atmospheric pressure and saturation reviewed and expressed on 1968 temperature scale. J Chem Eng Data. 1975;20(1):97-105.